The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Tirdas, the 13th of Frostfall (Tuesday, October 13, 2026) · Morning Edition — Vol. 2610, No. 13 · Price: One Septim



Gandy endures the rain under the eaves while Maevy bats at every drop.

Skies o'er the Hold

59° / 42°

Showers easing to partly cloudy — Flood Warning until 8 AM

Sunrise 6:29 AM · Sunset 5:53 PM

Tomorrow — Sunny, 63/45

Overheard Last Night

Heard at the market stall: Mabel bought two extra lanterns "for the long nights," she said — and bought them in a hurry.

The Moon's Reckoning



Yesterday New Moon · *Tonight* Waxing Crescent · *Tomorrow*

waxing toward the full moon

13th of Frostfall = October 13

Months run one-for-one all year

Sundas=Sun … Loredas=Sat

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Rain Over the Rim, and the Holds Still Bustle



Payson, Ariz.

Hail, wayfarer, and mind the puddles on the pine-needle road — Tirdas dawns wet over the Payson Hold, with showers this morning under a Flood Warning until 8 AM, easing toward a partly cloudy afternoon at 59 degrees. The rain does not stop the Holds: volunteers take to the trails in Pine at 7 AM, the rodeo committee gathers in Payson this evening, and Sedona's estate buyers open their strongboxes at 9 AM. Later in the week come folk harmonies in Payson on Thursday, country stars in Prescott Valley, and a bazaar and a Cowboy Prom in the Show Low country on Saturday. By the Nine, bring a cloak — and come along.



Trail Day in Pine: volunteers shape the path beneath the Rim while the Tirdas rain falls soft and steady.

Happening in the Holds Today

- **Payson**

  — Ukulele at the Payson Public Library — 10:30 AM, 328 N McLane Rd. Bring your ukulele and a desire to meet new friends, as the circle plays a mix of basic and intermediate songs. Beginners are welcome among the regulars, and the mood is easy and unhurried. A fine wet-morning refuge while the showers pass over the Hold.

  — PPRC Committee Meeting — 6:30–7:30 PM. The Payson Pro Rodeo Committee opens its doors to the public this evening. Hear how the Hold's famous rodeo is planned, meet the volunteers and committee members who make it run, and lend a hand if you've a mind to. Fans, helpers, and the merely curious are all welcome at the table.

- **Pine-Strawberry**

  — Trail Day Volunteer Build in Pine — from 7 AM, along Hwy 87 in Pine. Don't just use the trail — help build it. PINE Strawberry Fuel Reduction calls hikers, bikers, runners, and neighbors to clear brush, move rocks, break roots, and shape trails that will serve the Hold for years. The work also opens better access routes for firefighters, so every arm lent does double duty. Dress for wet ground and bring your good will.

- **Sedona**

  — Renee Taylor Jewelry Buying Event — 9 AM–6:30 PM, 313 AZ-179, Suite B14, Sedona (also Wednesday, and Thursday until 5:30 PM). Estate Buying Specialists will examine your gold, coins, fine jewelry, diamonds, sterling silver, watches, and other rarities, and give an honest evaluation on the spot. Sell, and payment is immediate — no appointment needed, just walk in. A fine chance to turn a drawer of old treasures into septims for the road.

- **Show Low**

  — Mahjong — 12:30 PM, 1594 Johnson Drive, Pinetop-Lakeside, just down the road from Show Low. Every Tuesday the tiles come out for an afternoon of strategy, laughter, and friendly rivalry. New players are welcomed into the game's fascinating rhythms, and regulars keep the table lively. A cozy indoor pastime while the mountain rain drums outside.

- **Prescott**

  — Intermediate Line Dance with Barb — 3 PM, 1280 E Rosser St, Suite B, Prescott. Barb leads the intermediate class through sequences and rhythms that build on the basic steps. Class fee is $8 for basic members, $15 for non-members. Expect good music, good company, and a workout that feels more like a mead-hall reel than exercise.

  — Line Dance Lessons — 6 PM, 214 S Montezuma St, Prescott. Dre Caldwell teaches this evening's lessons, and by the end of the night you'll be boot-scootin' like it's nobody's business. All comers are welcome to hang out, learn the steps, and join the line. A merry way to close a rainy Tirdas in the old capital.

The Days Ahead

- **Wed, Oct. 14**

  — **Baby Story Time at the Payson Public Library** — 10:30 AM, 328 N McLane Rd, Payson. The library celebrates its youngest readers with board books and songs, in a gentle half-hour made for babies and their grown-ups. It is a sweet first mead-hall for the Hold's smallest travelers, and a fine way to meet other young families. No registration is needed — just come and sing along.

- **Thu, Oct. 15**

  — **A Band Called Honalee** — 7 PM, 301 S McLane Rd, Payson. This modern-day folk trio relives the timeless magic of Peter, Paul & Mary, bringing classics like "Leaving on a Jet Plane," "Blowing in the Wind," and "Puff the Magic Dragon" to life. Stirring vocal harmonies carry every song, the way traveling bards once carried news between holds. A warm evening of songs the whole hall knows by heart.

  — **Gary Allan** — 7:30 PM, Findlay Toyota Center, Prescott Valley. The country powerhouse brings his signature grit and soul to the stage, with special guest Julie Eddy. Nearly three decades of hits — "Man to Man," "Every Storm (Runs Out of Rain)," and more — delivered with raspy, rebellious edge. A big-night outing for Valley Dwellers and Hold folk alike.

- **Fri, Oct. 16**

  — **Heber Ridge at The House** — 5:30 PM, The House, Show Low. Heber Ridge heads back to The House stage with a full-throttle blend of raw grit, deep soul, and pure outlaw country. Lock in the date for a Friday night of big voices and bigger choruses in the pines. Come hungry for music and leave humming it down the mountain road.

  — **Friday Nights at the Theater** — 7 PM, 110 Indian Cliffs Road, Sedona. The Arts Academy of Sedona presents the next installment of its beloved Friday Night at the Theater series, in its newly established performance home. An evening of live performance among the red rocks, where the bards of Sedona take the stage. A fine Fredas outing for guests who love a good show.

- **Sat, Oct. 17**

  — **Third Annual Autumn Bazaar** — 9 AM–2 PM, White Mountain United Methodist Church, 261 N 5th St, Show Low. Shop, eat, and enjoy: local makers fill the hall with autumn crafts, baked goods, and music. It is the kind of market where every stall holds a small treasure and every neighbor a story. A beautiful way to spend a fall Loredas in the White Mountains.

  — **Cowboy Prom for a Cause** — gates 5 PM, music 5:30–8:30 PM, Porter Mountain Stables, 3092 Jacks Rd, Pinetop-Lakeside. Heber Ridge headlines a night of live music, dancing, BBQ, and raffle and auction prizes — all to benefit the Johnson family as Tucker and Jenny fight a stage-three cancer diagnosis while raising their two little ones. Admission is $35 a person or $65 a couple, and every septim goes to stand behind this family. Dust off your best boots and show how strong this community stands.

- **Sun, Oct. 18**

  — **Sedona Community Farmers Market** — 8 AM–noon, 2201 W SR 89A, Sedona. Local growers and makers spread their tables under the red rocks for the Sunday market. Expect farm produce, baked goods, and handmade wares, with the morning light doing its famous work on the cliffs. Arrive early for the best pick of the harvest.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue since Sept. 26 — draw the sconces and ready them before a single torch can burn.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Overdue since Oct. 3 — the printers stand ready; give them their orders.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Overdue since Oct. 10 — hang the finished torches and light the way.
- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Due Saturday, Oct. 17 — the Hearth's arms take shape; mount it by the front door after.

The torches still wait overdue, and the shield is due Saturday, Oct. 17 — the Hearth's doorway wants its guardians hung and lit.



Torch sconces on the bench and the shield in the carving — the doorway guardians take shape.

Merchant of the Hold

Macky's Grill · *Payson*



The grill-master at work — Macky's burgers sizzle like a feast-day in the mead hall.

Home of "Payson's Best Burger," Macky's piles its platters high — the AZ Chili Bomber and the classic Macky's Burger lead a menu of grilled sandwiches, wings, calamari, and chicken fried steak, with butterscotch pie and carrot cake for the sweet finish. The mugs arrive frosty as if a minor frost charm lived in the kitchen, and the dog-friendly patio out back welcomes the whole traveling party, hounds included.

> *"Food is excellent and our server, Megan was the best server we have ever had!! We definitely be back."* — Yelp review

201 W Main St, Suite J, Payson · Tue–Sat 10 AM–8 PM, Sun 10 AM–4 PM, closed Mondays · (928) 474-7411 · $$ (about $10–20 a plate) · Good to know: the patio welcomes dogs, and the lunch rush fills the hall fast — come a little early. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you:
Because every quest party deserves a burger worth singing about — and Macky's serves Payson's best, with a patio where your hound is honored company.

Tales from the Treeline

The Rain-Tin Orchestra



Henny conducts, the tins play, and Earl endures his one-tin serenade.

Tirdas dawned wet, and Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) took it into his head that the rain was wasted falling unheard. By breakfast he had lined the Hearth's deck rail with every vessel he could borrow — Gus's pie tins, Mabel's watering cans, and one dented old helmet — each set to catch the rain and sing its own small note.

Henny (the Hearth's chicken) appointed herself conductor, as is her right. She mounted an upturned bucket, shook the rain off her comb, and flapped the whole orchestra into time, while the tins went plink, the cans went plonk, and the helmet, being deep, went bong at moments nobody expected.

Earl (an elk) wanted no part of the concert. He settled under the eaves for a dignified nap, but one pie tin had landed on his antlers, and it dripped — drip — drip — square between his eyes. Mabel (a wood elf) sighed, moved the tin two inches, and the drip fell harmless on the deck boards.

Earl slept the whole performance through. Jethro calls it his finest review.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Tirdas be free of giants, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com